

# CARN

A BOOK OF ASH & BONE



## The Adventurer's Manual

COMBAT / CREATURES / THE WORLD BEYOND THE GATE

MAXIMUM FORCE - MOCKUP EDITION 01

# The dead remember.

Before the marsh swallowed its roads, before ash filled the wells, the citadel kept a fire for every grave. So long as the fires burned, the dead were said to sleep.

Then the king demanded a flame that would never die. The furnaces worked through winter. The grave fires went cold. Under the city, something answered the hammers.

Now the soldiers walk without breath. Roots wear a crown beneath the drowned trees. Far below, a saint of iron tends a furnace that has forgotten what it was built to burn.

You have come with an axe and no banner. At the road's end you stack a few stones for those who will not return. There is still room for one more.



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EDITORIAL NOTE: Story passages and biographies are proposed lore for this mockup. Creature names and combat guidance follow the current game.

# The Barbarian

NO CROWN. NO COMPANY. ONE MORE MILE.



No herald remembers his name. He comes from the hard country beyond the roads, where a grave is marked with stones because timber is too precious to spare. He has buried kin, companions, and men he once meant to kill. He knows how much a cairn weighs.

He did not come to claim the citadel. He came because the dead have begun crossing the passes, and there is nowhere left to retreat. Whatever woke them must be reached on foot.

## ARMS & TEMPERAMENT

A double-headed axe, a stubborn stride, and a willingness to close the distance. Strength wins an opening; patience keeps it from becoming a trap.

*"A king leaves a monument. The rest of us leave stones."*

# The Restless Host



I

II

III

IV

V

## I / BONE WARRIOR

The grave has taken everything except the habit of violence. These scraps of soldiers drift toward the living, finding courage in numbers.

## II / LEGIONARY

An old oath held inside ruined armor. The face is gone; the formation survives. Never assume the first fallen soldier has left the road empty.

## III / SHIELD REVENANT

A shield raised for a kingdom that no longer exists. Watch the windup: the guard lowers just before the attack. That brief opening is your invitation.

## IV / SKELETON ARCHER

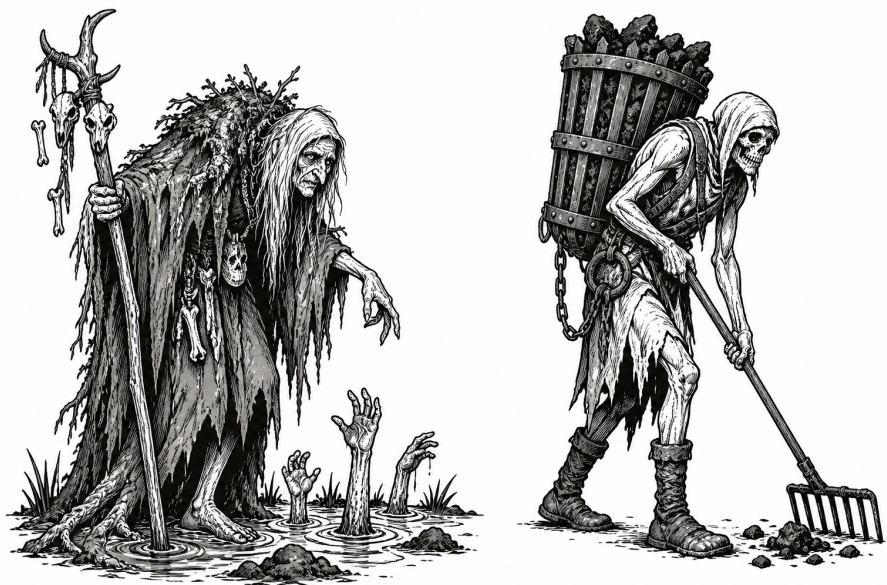
A patient hunter with neither pulse nor pity. It draws, fires, and retreats when pressed. Change your approach instead of chasing straight into the bow.

## V / MARAUDER

Not all who haunt the ruins are dead. Fur-clad raiders have made a trade of following the slaughter. Their committed rush punishes an idle target.



# Mire & Fire



## THE BOG WITCH

Before the roads sank, she knew every path through the reeds. Now she keeps the paths for herself. Her staff carries the little bones of travelers who trusted a voice in the fog.

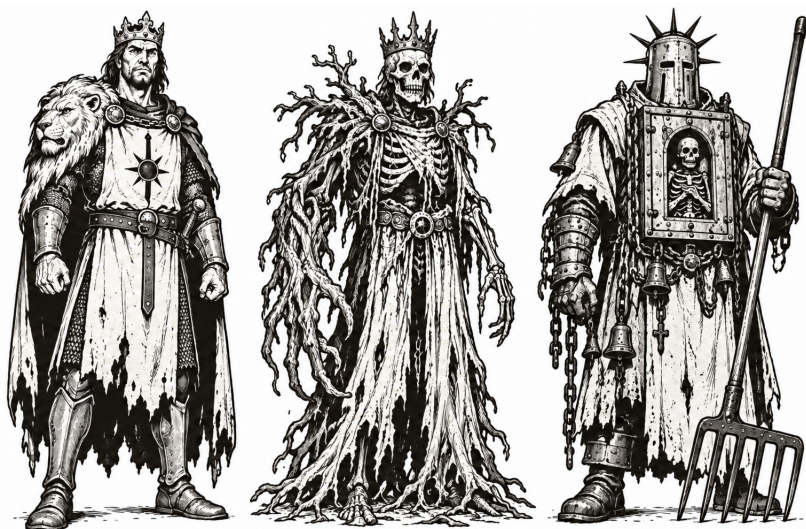
**In battle:** Her black mire grips the feet, weakens jumps, and drains life. Killing the witch clears her mire. Do not settle into a fight on ground she has chosen.

## THE FURNACE BEARER

The old furnaces needed hands long after the workers were buried. Bent beneath a load of slag, the bearer follows a shift bell that no living ear can hear.

**In battle:** Watch for thrown clinker and keep space to move. A crowded floor makes every ranged threat harder to escape.

# Lords of the Ruin



## THE CAIRN CHAMPION

The last bright thing in the fallen court. Crowned and armored, he still stands as though an audience waits beyond the gate. His kingdom has narrowed to the ground beneath his feet.

## THE DROWNED KING

He would not abandon his throne when the waters rose. The roots took his command literally. Now the marsh carries him, and his great wooden arm drags the drowned earth into battle.

## THE KILN SAINT

A sealed iron reliquary built to endure the heat below. Within its chest lies the small remnant of the thing once called holy. Its chains drag through ash; its rake still tends the fire.

**A word to the reckless:** The King and Saint resist ordinary blows while closed. Read their attacks, survive the commitment, and answer when their defenses open.

# Three Forsaken Lands



## I / THE FALLEN CITADEL

Walls built to keep death outside now hold it in. Broken courtyards lead toward the Champion, still keeping his last watch.



## II / THE SUNKEN WILDS

The road goes under the water. Reeds hide the stones; roots hide the dead. Somewhere beyond the mist, a king refuses to sink.



## III / THE ASHEN DEPTHS

Below the world, the work continues. Chains swing over cold ash and the furnace doors breathe. The Kiln Saint is waiting.

*Three episodes. Four areas in each. A lord at the end of the road.*

# The Art of Staying Alive

|                      |                                        |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| MOVE                 | W A S D or arrow keys                  |
| RUN                  | Hold Shift, or double-tap left / right |
| SWING                | J or Z                                 |
| CROWD BREAKER        | Hold J; release before the next spin   |
| JUMP / DIVING STRIKE | Space (also K / X); J while airborne   |
| BACK ATTACK          | J + Space together on the ground       |
| MAGIC                | L or C when the mana meter is full     |
| CHANGE WEAPON        | Q                                      |
| PAUSE / RESUME       | Escape or P                            |

**Fight on your terms.** Line up with your target before swinging. Leave room to retreat, watch the bowstring, and save a diving strike for an opening you can reach. A missed landing gives the enemy time to answer.

**Earn your magic.** Successful melee hits build mana. When full, finish your current action and cast from the ground. Keep an eye on the meter while the crowd is still manageable.



**Leave a stone. Keep walking.**